system of government and spoke English. But due to different historical backgrounds, the two countries did not have a common approach to various international issues. While India adopted the policy of non-alignment after Independence, Australia entered into a military alliance with the USA and New Zealand as early as in 1951. These differences, however, did not come in the way of the two countries improving their bilateral relations through mutual contacts and exchanges in economic and cultural fields.

Nevertheless, the Indian government felt that Indian entrepreneurs could provide invaluable assistance in Fiji through collaboration projects. An Indian techno-economic team was sent to Fiji to explore the possibilities of setting up small scale industries and also identify the different areas where invest-NFP in his cabinet. They did not know that the government was about to head straight into a bloody war/ Shekhawat said, recalling some of the intelligence cables that the R&AW had received from Suva. He explained, 'After the defeat of the Alliance party, conspirators united to oppose the installation of a multiracial government. Raiwaqa, a neighbourhood in Suva, had become the strategic command centre of rebels led by hardliner ethnic Fijian politicians. An intelligence cable in late April 1987 had hinted that certain Fijian leaders were talking about protests and a possible coup against the government. It was proved, beyond doubt, that they were supported by the Fijians. Petitions were filed with the governor general Ratu Sir Penaia Kanatabatu Ganilau to dismiss the elected government. Violent protests were being organised by mushrooming Fijian civil society groups and associations against the government. The new born government, a true multiracial government, was in deep trouble.'